

Blue-Tongue Skink Setup Checklist

Before purchase

- Confirm species, subspecies or locality: Northern, Eastern, Indonesian, Merauke and shingleback-type skinks are not identical.
- Ask for captive-bred status, feeding history, age, weight, shedding history, recent photos and seller knowledge of the exact form.
- Find an experienced reptile veterinarian before an urgent problem appears.
- Do not use a single universal skink care number unless the source is truly about the exact species being kept.
- Treat temperature, humidity, substrate, lighting, diet and behavior as one husbandry system rather than isolated settings.
- Record observations in writing so changes in appetite, weight, shed quality and behavior are visible over time.

Core equipment

- Secure terrestrial enclosure with enough adult floor area, hides and a safe thermal gradient.
- Thermostat-controlled heating with measured basking and cool areas rather than wattage guesses.
- Species-appropriate UVB, visible light cycle, shade, substrate and water access.
- Humidity planning that follows the exact species/locality instead of a generic blue-tongue rule.

Avoid

- Do not buy the animal first and upgrade later.
- Do not heat the whole enclosure evenly or leave no cool retreat.
- Do not copy humidity or brumation advice from another blue-tongue type without checking evidence.

Use with the full Skinkpedia article. Exact values change by species, age, locality, enclosure design and health status. This resource is educational and does not replace species-specific husbandry research or reptile-veterinary advice.